

Once you select software for installation, USC will automatically find out which other packages are needed to make software run and installs them. These additional software package(s) required to make a particular software run are called dependencies. If you wonder why is it necessary at all, let us get back to the description of `/lib` directory. We already said that Linux maintains a single set of software libraries. We also gave a simple example where we said that if a software (say a picture management application) wants to use the Bluetooth device connected to the computer, it will have to use the library which can communicate with the hardware and get the work done for the software. In this case, the first software (the picture manager application) depends on the Bluetooth library without which it might not work properly. In such a condition, we call the package which provides the Bluetooth library as a dependency for the picture manager application.

Using Ubuntu Software Centre is not the only way to install new software. For a finer level control, you might have to start up the Synaptic Package Manager which does the same work as Ubuntu Software Centre. The difference lies in the level of control offered by these two different looking programs. While Ubuntu Software Center (Ok, let's call it USC henceforth) simply shows you the software which you want to install, Synaptic shall show you both the requirements, the dependencies, the size to be downloaded and consumed after the installation of the software, individual file progresses and a lot more options to choose from. Synaptic is for those who understand what software packages are and how to install them. Using Synaptic package manager is slightly more difficult than using USC.

Installing software in a more geeky way

Ubuntu is a Linux distribution and as they say, Linux is for geeks. Although Ubuntu makes it too easy on you by offering you really nice and cool ways to search and install software, there always is a more sophisticated way to do it. To install software from the terminal, you should know the right commands to be used. Before installing the software however, you must get the updated list of software from the Ubuntu servers, at least once. Performing any software install using built-in commands for package management would require internet connection (except when you are removing them).

The most used command for installing software from the command line is 'apt-get'. To get the updated list of packages from the Ubuntu servers, run:

- `sudo apt-get update`